

United States History and Geography — Student Form

United States History and Geography · Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28 · Form FORM-B

classroom-formative · pre-field-test. Item parameters are estimates and have not met a student; this form is not a calibrated instrument. This is a selected-response form. It assesses Depth of Knowledge levels 1 through 3. It carries no extended-response item, so it does not assess DOK-4 — a four-option question cannot ask a student to construct and defend an argument. Extended responses and document-based questions are delivered as separate activities.

1. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the signing ceremony for the North Atlantic Treaty on April 4, 1949. The treaty created the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO), a mutual defense alliance between the United States, Canada, and ten Western European nations. (Photograph, April 4, 1949. Public Domain.) What was the PRIMARY purpose of the alliance created by the treaty shown being signed in this photograph?

- A.** To establish free trade among Western nations
- B.** To create a unified European government
- C.** To dismantle colonial empires in Asia and Africa
- D.** To provide collective defense against Soviet aggression in Europe

2. What was the satellite state system in Eastern Europe?

- A.** Eastern European countries controlled by the Soviet Union after World War II
- B.** Independent nations that voluntarily formed economic partnerships with the USSR
- C.** Asian countries that cooperated on space technology with the Soviet program
- D.** Western European nations that received economic aid from the United States

3. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the NATO treaty signing, April 4, 1949. (Photograph, 1949. Public Domain.) How did the creation of NATO, shown in this photograph, represent a departure from traditional American foreign policy?

- A.** NATO was a temporary agreement that expired after five years
- B.** It was the first peacetime military alliance in American history
- C.** The alliance required no military commitment from the United States
- D.** The United States had long maintained peacetime military alliances in Europe

4. How did the formation of NATO and the Warsaw Pact reflect the ideological competition between the United States and the Soviet Union during the Cold War?

- A.** The alliances reflected agreement between superpowers on the need for collective disarmament
- B.** Both alliances were formed primarily for economic cooperation rather than military defense
- C.** They split Europe into rival military blocs, one capitalist and one communist
- D.** NATO and the Warsaw Pact were created jointly to prevent a third world war between smaller nations

5. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows a U.S. Air Force C-54 Skymaster cargo plane flying low over a crowd of German civilians as it approaches Tempelhof Airport in Berlin during the summer of 1948. (Photograph, 1948. U.S. Air Force.) To what extent did early Cold War confrontations like the one shown in this photograph shape the formation of military alliances in Europe?

- A.** The crisis led both the U.S. and Soviet Union to immediately reduce their military presence in Europe
- B.** The crisis had no lasting impact because the Soviet Union voluntarily ended the blockade
- C.** The crisis was resolved through the United Nations, proving that international organizations alone could maintain peace
- D.** The crisis accelerated the creation of NATO as Western nations sought collective security against Soviet aggression

6. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the NATO treaty signing, 1949. (Photograph, 1949. Public Domain.) Analyze how NATO fit into the broader containment strategy of the United States during the early Cold War.

- A.** NATO was the military component of containment — complementing the Truman Doctrine's political commitment and the Marshall Plan's economic support to prevent Soviet expansion into Western Europe
- B.** NATO was unrelated to containment and was created solely for economic cooperation
- C.** NATO replaced the containment policy with a strategy of direct military confrontation with the Soviet Union
- D.** The containment strategy relied entirely on nuclear weapons and did not include alliances